Week 04: Research Funding in Türkiye: Programmes, Criteria and Processes

R&D and Project Management in Computer Science

R&D and Project Management in Computer Science (11117BLG002). Prof. Dr. Utku Kose. Full Professor, Department of Computer Engineering, Süleyman Demirel University, Isparta, Türkiye. Additional affiliations: University of North Dakota (USA), Universidad Panamericana (Mexico City, Mexico), Vel Tech University (Chennai, India). ORCID 0000-0002-9652-6415. E-mail: utkukose@sdu.edu.tr, utku.kose@und.edu, ukose@up.edu.mx, utkukose@gmail.com. This course is updated in line with current developments in the field. First version: September 2026. Last update: October 2026.

Overview

Most research projects in Türkiye are funded by a small number of public bodies with well-defined programmes. This week maps the programme families of TÜBİTAK and other public funders, explains how TÜBİTAK evaluates research proposals and turns the requirements into a practical plan. Programme names and rules were checked against official sources in September 2026 and must be re-checked before any application [1, 2].

Learning outcomes

By the end of the week, students are expected to identify suitable funding programmes in Türkiye for a given profile and purpose. They should be able to explain the evaluation criteria and formal requirements of TÜBİTAK's research programmes and to plan the internal timeline of an application.

Lecture

The funding landscape

TÜBİTAK, the Scientific and Technological Research Council of Türkiye, runs the largest set of programmes, organised in directorates, as Figure 4.1 summarises. The Directorate of Research Support Programmes (ARDEB) funds academic research. Examples are the 1001 programme for scientific and technological research projects, the 1002 rapid support programme, the 1003 programme for priority areas and the 3501 career development programme for young researchers. The Directorate of Technology and Innovation Support Programmes (TEYDEB) funds industrial research and development. Its programmes include the 1501 industrial R&D programme, the 1507 programme for R&D start-ups of small and medium enterprises and the 1505 university-industry collaboration programme. They also include the 1509 programme for international industrial projects and the 1512 entrepreneurship programme known as BiGG. The Directorate of Science Fellowships and Grant Programmes (BİDEB) supports people. Examples are the 2209 programmes for undergraduate research

projects, the 2244 industrial doctorate programme, the 2218 national postdoctoral programme and the 2232 programme for international leading and returning researchers.

Other public funders complement TÜBİTAK. The Ministry of Industry and Technology grants incentives to firms with R&D and design centres under Law No. 5746 and to companies in technology development zones under Law No. 4691 [3, 4]. KOSGEB supports research and innovation in small and medium enterprises. The development agencies established under Law No. 5449 run regional support programmes [5]. Universities fund projects through their scientific research projects units, known as BAP.

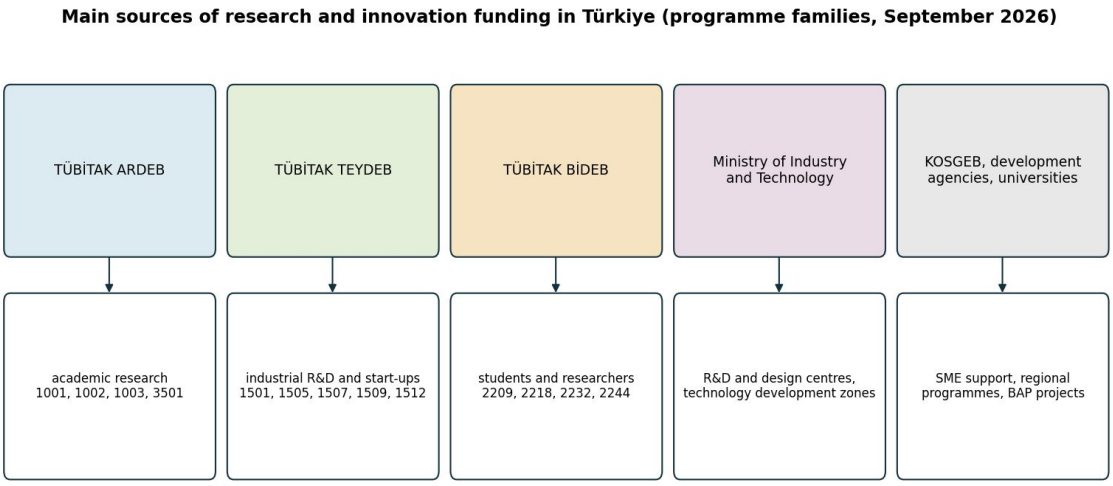


Figure 4.1. Programme families of the main public funders of research and innovation in Türkiye, checked against official sources in September 2026 [3, 4, 5].

How TÜBİTAK evaluates research proposals

In the 1001 programme, proposals are evaluated under four criteria with equal weight: originality, method, project management and wider impact [1]. In Turkish, they are known as özgün değer, yöntem, proje yönetimi and yaygın etki. The budget of the programme is set for each application period. The application form asks for Turkish and English summaries of up to 600 words each that cover the four criteria. The main text, excluding annexes, should not exceed 25 pages [2]. The form also asks for a plan B for the main risks, which must not lead the project away from its core objectives and originality. The 1002-A rapid support module uses the same four criteria with a limit of 12 pages [6]. TÜBİTAK has also awarded additional points for elements such as the increase in technology readiness level and alignment with priority areas in its call planning [1].

Matching programmes to profiles

The first decision is not how to write but where to apply. Consider an undergraduate with a research idea, a doctoral student working with a company, an early-career researcher building a group and a small enterprise developing a product. Each of them faces different programmes, with different rules on eligibility, partners, budgets and duration. The interactive lab provides a

navigator that suggests programme families for a profile and purpose and links to the official pages. It is a starting point, and the current call documents always take precedence, because programme numbers, budget limits and deadlines change.

Planning the application

A proposal needs more than writing time. Institutions usually require internal approval before submission, ethics committee approval may be needed for studies with human participants or personal data, and colleagues need time to review drafts. Working backwards from the deadline, the Colab notebook computes the dates of these internal milestones in business days. A realistic plan also leaves time for budget preparation with the institution's project office or technology transfer office, whose staff often know the current rules in detail.

> ***Pause and reflect.*** *Which programme in the navigator fits your project idea best, and which eligibility condition is most likely to exclude you?*

Hands-on components

Interactive lab: Part A suggests programme families for a profile and purpose, with links to official pages; always read the current call. Part B rates a draft against the four equally weighted criteria of the 1001 programme and plans the page budget. Part C counts the words of a summary [1, 2]. Link: https://utkukose.github.io/rd-project-management-NB-lecture/weeks/week-04/lab.html

Colab notebook: It plans the internal timeline of an application by working backwards from the deadline in business days, and summarises a draft budget by category. Link: https://colab.research.google.com/github/utkukose/rd-project-management-NB-lecture/blob/main/weeks/week-04/NB04_funding_turkiye.ipynb

Reflection prompts

1. Which programme would you apply to first with your project idea, and why that one rather than the alternatives?
2. Which of the four TÜBİTAK criteria is the weakest in your current idea, and what would strengthen it?
3. Which internal step at your institution takes longest, and how will you plan around it?

Weekly task and submission

What to do. Prepare a funding plan for your project, about 400 words. First, name the programme you will target and explain why it fits your profile. Second, list its eligibility conditions as stated in the current call. Third, plan a timeline of internal milestones, working backwards from the deadline. Fourth, draft a budget by category. Cite the official call documents.

Where to look. Lecture: sections "The funding landscape", "Matching programmes to profiles" and "Planning the application". Interactive lab: Part A, which suggests programme families for a profile and purpose, and Part B, a self-check against the four criteria of the 1001 programme. Colab notebook: Section 1 for the timeline and Section 2 for the draft budget.

Example. A doctoral student could target the TÜBİTAK 1001 programme with the supervisor as project leader. The timeline could set a complete draft four weeks before the deadline and the request for institutional approval two weeks before it. The budget could list personnel, equipment, consumables, travel and services.

What to submit. About 400 words with the timeline and the budget table, and the Colab notebook with Exercises 1 and 2 completed.

The weekly task supports self-learning and builds a personal portfolio. In an active semester, students who follow the course with the instructor can send their work for evaluation to utkukose@sdu.edu.tr or utkukose@gmail.com. The e-mail contains the items that the task lists under What to submit. It also includes the learning log exported from the interactive lab (tab: Reflect and submit).

References

[1] TÜBİTAK (2020). ARDEB 1001 Programı: Proje değerlendirme sistemindeki yenilikler. https://tubitak.gov.tr/tr/duyuru/ardeb-1001-programi-proje-degerlendirme-sistemindeki-yenilikler

[2] TÜBİTAK (2026). 1001 Bilimsel ve Teknolojik Araştırma Projelerini Destekleme Programı: Proje başvuru formu. https://tubitak.gov.tr/sites/default/files/20689/1001_basvuru_formu.doc

[3] Republic of Türkiye (2008). Law No. 5746 on Supporting Research, Development and Design Activities (Araştırma, Geliştirme ve Tasarım Faaliyetlerinin Desteklenmesi Hakkında Kanun). https://www.mevzuat.gov.tr

[4] Republic of Türkiye (2001). Law No. 4691 on Technology Development Zones (Teknoloji Geliştirme Bölgeleri Kanunu). https://www.mevzuat.gov.tr

[5] Republic of Türkiye (2006). Law No. 5449 on the Establishment, Coordination and Duties of Development Agencies (Kalkınma Ajanslarının Kuruluşu, Koordinasyonu ve Görevleri Hakkında Kanun). https://www.mevzuat.gov.tr

[6] TÜBİTAK (2026). 1002 Hızlı Destek Programı: 1002-A proje başvuru formu. https://tubitak.gov.tr/sites/default/files/20689/1002_a_basvuru_formu.doc